

MERIDIAN COUNTY PUBLIC WORKS

Request for Proposals RFP-2025-114: Wastewater Treatment Plant Upgrade

Section 4 — Bid Responsiveness Requirements

4.1 Purpose of This Section

This section defines the mandatory components that every bid submission must contain to be considered responsive. Bid responsiveness is a threshold determination made before any evaluation of price or technical merit. A bid that omits any mandatory component is non-responsive and must be rejected without further evaluation. Responsiveness is not a scored factor and is not subject to the price or technical comparison; it is a pass or fail gate.

4.2 Mandatory Components

To be responsive, a bid must contain all eight of the following components. The absence of any one renders the bid non-responsive regardless of the strength of the remaining components or the competitiveness of the price.

(1) Signed Bid Form — The official bid form, signed and dated by an authorised representative of the bidder.

(2) Completed Price Schedule — An itemised price schedule covering all line items in Appendix A, with a total bid price.

(3) Technical Proposal — A narrative describing the bidder's approach, methodology, schedule, and key personnel.

(4) Bid Bond — A bid bond or certified bid security equal to 5% of the total bid price, issued by a licensed surety. The bid bond guarantees that the bidder will enter into the contract if awarded. This component is mandatory and may not be waived or submitted after the bid deadline.

(5) Certificate of Non-Collusion — A signed certification that the bid was prepared independently and without collusion with any other bidder.

(6) Evidence of Insurance — A certificate of insurance or insurer's letter evidencing the coverage levels required in Section 6.

(7) List of Subcontractors — A list identifying each subcontractor the bidder intends to use and the scope each will perform.

(8) Signed Addendum Acknowledgement — A signed acknowledgement confirming receipt of all addenda issued during the solicitation period.

4.3 Determination of Responsiveness

The procurement officer shall examine each bid for the presence of all eight mandatory components. A component is present only if the corresponding document or content is actually included in the submission. A statement in a cover letter or transmittal that a component is enclosed does not satisfy the requirement if the component itself is not present in the submission. Bids found non-responsive shall be set aside and

shall not be ranked against responsive bids.

4.4 Award Basis

Among responsive bids only, award shall be recommended to the bidder offering the lowest total bid price. Non-responsive bids are not eligible for award irrespective of price.